Social Media Analytics

Syllabus for MC 427: Fall 2026 (Second Eight Weeks)

Social Media Analytics

Part of the AI Social Media Strategist Certificate Program (Joint SIUE + SIUC)

Instructor Information

The table below lists the instructor's contact details, department and program affiliation, course format and duration, office location, and office-hour times.

Field	Information
Professor	Alex P. Leith, PhD
Department	Department of Mass Communications, SIUE. See the SIUE Mass Communications department directory at siue.edu for office and phone.
Program / Advising	AI Social Media Strategist Certificate, a joint program of SIUE and SIUC. For advising on the certificate, contact Academic Advising (linked below) or your assigned advisor.
Email	aleith@siue.edu
Course Format	Fully online (asynchronous content); weekly remote office hours by appointment
Course Duration	October 19 to December 18, 2026
Office	1017 Dunham Hall
Office Hours	Remote, Tuesday through Thursday, 3:00 to 5:00 p.m., over Teams by appointment, scheduled through Microsoft Bookings or by email. Office hours are not recorded.
Schedule Time	Book a remote 1:1 through *Microsoft Bookings* (my calendar shows only open times), or email aleith@siue.edu

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Welcome

Welcome to MC 427, Social Media Analytics, the analytical anchor of the AI Social Media Strategist Certificate program. This certificate is a joint offering of SIUE and SIUC and is designed for students who want to enter the workforce as strategists who can supervise, govern, and account for AI-augmented analytical work.

This course teaches you to use AI tools as collaborative partners for analyzing social media data and designing strategy, and just as importantly, to evaluate AI outputs with

the critical eye of a strategist who is accountable for what gets posted in their name. We will treat AI logging and governance as professional skills, not afterthoughts. By the end of the course you will have produced a pitch-ready campaign deck supported by your own analytical work, an AI Workflow Appendix that documents how AI helped you build it, and a personal governance practice you can carry into the workforce. Successful completion of MC 427 contributes toward the **AI Social Media Strategist Certificate Credly badge**; the course is also designed to prepare students who want to take the free HubSpot Social Media Marketing Certification as a portable industry credential.

About the Instructor

I am Alex P. Leith, also known as AP. Please feel free to call me Alex, AP, or Dr. Leith. My pronouns are he/they. I have been at SIUE since Fall 2019. I am a social data scientist that specializes in digital social platforms (livestreaming, virtual reality, and conversational AI). My research uses natural language processing across platforms ranging from Twitter to Twitch to long-form interview corpora. I am also the operator of SIM DAD LLC, a small software company that builds local-first analytical tools for researchers and strategists. AI-augmented analytical practice is the daily work I do as both an academic and a builder.

Teaching Philosophy

My approach to teaching is direct. I believe that students learn in many ways and that the best thing a teacher can do is be available. In an asynchronous online course, “being available” looks different than in person. It means dedicated weekly office hours, held remotely by appointment, written feedback delivered on schedule, recorded video walkthroughs of common challenges, and discussion forums where I am a regular participant rather than an absentee landlord.

Communicating with the Instructor

The communication model in this course is built around **weekly office hours**. Those are the canonical channel for instructor-student support.

- **Office hours (synchronous, weekly):** the primary support channel. This course is fully online, so its office hours are held remotely on Tuesday, Wednesday and Thursday from 3:00 to 5:00 p.m. over Teams. Book a time through *Microsoft Bookings*, which shows you only my open times, or by email. Office hours are never recorded, so you can speak freely about grades, accommodations, or anything else.

- **Email (aleith@siue.edu):** for formal requests, time-non-sensitive questions, and confidential issues (grades, accommodations). Expect a response within 24 hours on weekdays.
- **Course Discussion forums (Blackboard):** the place for student-to-student discussion. I will participate periodically but will not monitor continuously; bring instructor-directed questions to office hours or email.

There is no Discord channel for this section. The course's communication architecture is intentionally narrow so the channels that exist work well.

In all communication: clearly stated needs save us both time. State what you have tried, what is not working, and what kind of response you are hoping for.

About the Course

Course Description (SIUE Catalog)

This course focuses on the use of analytics, including AI-powered tools, to evaluate and improve social media performance. Students learn to collect, analyze, and interpret data from multiple platforms using machine learning for pattern recognition and predictive analytics. Emphasis is placed on connecting metrics to organizational objectives, using insights to inform strategic decisions, and critically assessing the impact and limitations of AI in social media analytics.

Your Role and the Client

Every student plays one role for the whole term: an outside analyst hired by Hello Games, the studio that makes No Man's Sky, for one eight-week engagement. You report to the studio's Community Manager. Each week the client asks for one piece of work, you deliver it, and the pieces add up to a campaign pitch you can show an employer.

The company and the data are real: public Steam reviews, Steam player counts, public YouTube uploads, and an archived set of public posts on X. The engagement is a teaching scenario. Hello Games has not hired anyone in this course, is not a partner in it, and has not reviewed it, and the Community Manager who speaks in the course is a role written for the course, not a Hello Games employee. Please do not contact Hello Games or its staff as if you were working for them. Grading, feedback, and office hours come from me as your instructor, outside the scenario.

Place in the Certificate Program

The AI Social Media Strategist Certificate is a joint SIUE + SIUC program. MC 427 is the **methodological core**: the course where you learn the analytical methods AI tools automate, so you can supervise and account for them when they do. Adjacent courses cover the workflow design that automates analytics (MC 425), creative content

production (MC 328), AI advertising (JRNL 307), AI and misinformation (JRNL 438), and generative arts (AM 400).

Course Goals

By the end of the course, students will be able to do the following.

1. **Apply AI-augmented analytical methods**, including basic numerical and statistical concepts, to evaluate social media performance, audience behavior, and campaign outcomes, choosing research methods that fit the question and judging the quality of the information they produce.
2. **Design data-driven social media strategies** using AI tools as collaborative partners, applying tools and technologies appropriate for strategic communication work and grounding each recommendation in evidence you have gathered and evaluated.
3. **Critically evaluate AI outputs, your own analytical work, and the work of your peers** for accuracy, fairness, and ethical implications, with attention to the cultural and demographic dimensions of AI bias, such as errors on dialect, slang, or race- and gender-associated language that fall harder on some communities' posts than on others.
4. **Communicate analytical findings clearly and correctly** in written, visual, and presentation forms, using tools appropriate to the communications professions and to the audiences and purposes the work serves.
5. **Govern AI usage** through documented logging, oversight, and accountability practices, reviewing each decision to accept, modify, or reject an AI contribution against the professional ethical principles of truth, accuracy, fairness, and service.

Credentialing Pathway

Primary credential: AI Social Media Strategist Certificate (Credly badge). The certificate program issues a Credly digital badge upon completion of the certificate's required courses. MC 427 is one of the courses that contributes to that badge. The Credly badge is the primary verifiable credential the program offers; it is portable, shareable, and verifiable by employers via the Credly platform.

Industry certification preparation (recommended optional). Students completing this syllabus are also well-prepared to earn industry-recognized social media certifications. The recommended primary industry pathway is the HubSpot Social Media Marketing Certification, offered free by HubSpot Academy and completed in approximately five hours. Students who complete the HubSpot certification during or shortly after the course can submit proof of completion for a small bonus credit. The HubSpot certification is positioned as a professional-practice extension; it is not required for course credit.

Alternative or follow-on industry certifications:

- **Hootsuite Social Media Marketing Certification** ($199 standard; check Hootsuite Academy for current student pricing), strong industry recognition, covers multi-platform management.
- **Meta Social Media Marketing Professional Certificate** (Coursera subscription, ~5 months), a long-form pathway with AI-integrated curriculum and ACE credit recommendation; suitable as a post-course continuation.

Course Materials

Textbooks

This course has no textbook to purchase. Course readings are instructor-authored and provided in each module, alongside assigned open-access articles and reports linked from the module pages. Every assigned external reading is free to access.

Software and Tools

The course uses one generative AI tool and free analytical software. All required tools are free or have free tiers sufficient for course use. No experience with R, statistics, or coding is needed: every step is taught in the course, starting with setup in Module 1.

- **Generative AI**: ChatGPT (free tier), Claude (free tier), or equivalent. Pick one as your primary and use it throughout the course; you only need one.
- **GitHub Copilot** (required): free for verified students through the Copilot Student plan, part of the *GitHub Education Pack*. Built into current versions of VS Code; you sign in with your GitHub account. As of March 2026, GitHub routes student requests through Auto mode (the system selects from OpenAI / Anthropic / Google models on each request); premium-model selection is no longer student-accessible. Auto mode is sufficient for the analytical work in Module 5 and the variability is itself pedagogically useful for the governance focus of the course.
- **VS Code** with the R extension: free; it is where you run R in this course.
- **AURA Lab R Companion** (optional, free): a VS Code extension made for this course that checks your setup, explains R messages, and offers menus that write R code into your script.
- **R**: free; install separately from VS Code, along with the free tidyverse and effectsize packages for R. Step-by-step setup guides for Windows, Mac, and Chromebook are in Start Here.
- **Not required:** Canva and social listening tools (Brand24, Sprout Social, Hootsuite) appear in course examples. No assignment requires them, and you do not need an account with any of them.

You are not expected to become an expert with any single tool. Fluency across the AI-augmented workflow plus the discipline to govern your own AI use is the goal.

Technology Requirements

A reliable computer and internet connection are required. Specific to this course:

- Webcam and microphone for the Module 8 Elevator Pitch video and remote office-hour appointments.
- A current version of a supported browser: Google Chrome, Microsoft Edge, Mozilla Firefox, or Apple Safari. Keep your browser updated to the latest release for the AI tool web interfaces to work reliably.
- If you use a pop-up blocker or a strict privacy extension, allow pop-up windows from the AI tools used in this course. Several tools open authentication or output windows that a blocker can silently suppress.
- A Windows or Mac computer or a Chromebook for the course software, which you set up in Module 1. The R work (R, VS Code, and GitHub Copilot) cannot be completed on a phone or tablet. On a Chromebook you use a GitHub Codespace, which runs VS Code in your web browser with nothing to install; the Chromebook setup guide in Start Here walks through it.
- Sufficient browser support for AI tool web interfaces.
- Storage: course produces ~1 to 2 GB of analytical artifacts; cloud storage (OneDrive, Google Drive, Dropbox) recommended.
- Microsoft Teams, either the installed app or Teams in a web browser (free for SIUE/SIUC students through campus license).
- VS Code, R, and Copilot installed and working by the end of Module 1. Start Here includes written setup guides for Windows, Mac, and Chromebook, and the Module 1 Tools Stack Setup assignment includes a two-minute test that confirms your setup works.

Course Requirements

AI Use Policy (Course-Specific Override of Default SIUE Policy)

This course is part of the AI Social Media Strategist Certificate Program. SIUE's default policy ("AI use is prohibited unless expressly allowed") is **expressly overridden for this course**. AI use is not just permitted but **required** as a learning outcome.

What is required:

- Use of one or more generative AI tools as collaborative partners across all major assignments.
- **Logging** of your AI use in the AI Use Log that runs through every module: which tool, what prompt(s), what the AI produced, what you kept, what you changed, what oversight decisions you made, and why.

- **Critical evaluation** of AI outputs in your own voice. Submitting an AI output verbatim without critique earns a low grade even if the output is correct.
- **Governance discipline**: every analytical step that incorporates AI gets a documented decision about whether to accept, modify, or reject the AI's contribution.
- Code written by the AURA Lab R Companion's menus is not AI-generated and needs no AI Use Log entry. Keep the comment it writes above each block, and be able to explain every line you submit.

What is not permitted:

- Submitting AI-generated work as your own without disclosure of AI involvement. This is academic dishonesty.
- Using AI to fabricate citations, data, or analytical results. The course teaches that AI hallucinates and that strategists are accountable; submitting fabricated material indicates this lesson did not land.
- Using AI to circumvent learning objectives (for example, having an AI write your final reflection from your other submissions).

The strategist standard: in industry, a senior strategist is accountable for AI-augmented work that goes out under their name. The same standard applies here. You are accountable for what you submit, including whatever role AI played in producing it.

The AI Use Log assignments are formative: they exist to build the habit, not to penalize early-stage workflows. Quality of governance reasoning matters more than quantity of logged interactions.

Submitting Work

All submissions go through Blackboard. Most major assignments require an AI Use Log excerpt or attached chat transcript; submission instructions specify the format.

Credit Hours and Time on Task

MC 427 is a 3-credit-hour course. Under the federal credit-hour definition, each credit hour represents about 45 hours of student work across the term, so plan for about 135 hours in total. The assigned work in the table below comes to about 83 hours: Modules 1 and 2 take about 5 to 6 hours each, and Modules 3 through 8 about 10 to 14 hours each. Use the rest of your 135 hours for review, practice in R, any resubmissions you choose to make, and the optional HubSpot certification.

The table below estimates the time each module takes. Videos and readings are measured from the course materials: lecture runtime, plus reading time at 200 words per minute for course readings and 150 words per minute for journal articles, counting

only the sections each module assigns. Assignment time is estimated from point value, plus the short weekly R practice. Module 8 is estimated from the new work it asks for, because its pitch deck, AI Workflow Appendix, and Final Reflection assemble work you will already have done.

Module	Dates	Videos and readings (hours)	Assignments (hours)	Estimated total (hours)
1	Oct 19 to 25	1.8	3.5	5.3
2	Oct 26 to Nov 1	2.7	3.4	6.1
3	Nov 2 to 8	3.8	6.4	10.2
4	Nov 9 to 15	3.5	8.4	11.9
5	Nov 16 to 22	3.3	8.1	11.4
6	Nov 30 to Dec 6	3.9	7.8	11.7
7	Dec 7 to 13	3.0	9.8	12.8
8	Dec 14 to 18	2.5	11.1 (estimated from new work)	13.6
Total		**24.5**	**58.5**	**83.0**

Module 8 holds 280 of the 731 points in a five-day week, but most of that work reuses what you build earlier. Start the AI Workflow Appendix when it opens in Module 7, and in each week's AI Use Log entry add two lines: mark the entry you would put in your Appendix, and write one sentence on what changed in how you use AI. By Module 8, the Appendix and the Final Reflection are then mostly selection.

Grading

Assignment Breakdown

> **Key:** F = Formative (completion + genuine effort); S = Summative (rubric-graded mastery); P = Participation

The table below lists each assignment with its module, type (formative, summative, or participation), and point value, followed by module subtotals and the course total.

Assignment	Mod	Type	Points
Syllabus Quiz	1	F	6
Introduction Discussion	1	P	10
AI Tool Inventory	1	F	5
Tools Stack Setup	1	F	5
AI Use Log: Week 1	1	F	5

Assignment	Mod	Type	Points
Module 1 subtotal			***31***
AI-Assisted KPI Mapping Exercise	2	S	15
Platform Reflection Discussion	2	P	10
AI Use Log: Week 2	2	F	5
Module 2 subtotal			***30***
AI-Assisted Research Plan	3	S	50
AI Use Log: Week 3	3	F	10
Module 3 subtotal			***60***
Coding Exercise	4	F	15
Comparison Memo	4	S	45
Disagreement Discussion	4	P	10
AI Use Log: Week 4	4	F	10
Module 4 subtotal			***80***
Mini-Analysis Exercise	5	F	20
Statistical Analysis Memo	5	S	45
AI Use Log: Week 5	5	F	15
Module 5 subtotal			***80***
AI Creative Brief Exercise	6	S	50
Peer Review	6	P	10
AI Use Log: Week 6	6	F	15
Module 6 subtotal			***75***
SWOT Draft	7	S	30
Timeline Draft	7	S	30
Peer Review of Draft Strategy Work	7	P	20
AI Use Log: Week 7	7	F	15
Module 7 subtotal			***95***
Final Pitch Deck	8	S	150
AI Workflow Appendix	8	S	50
Elevator Pitch	8	S	30
Final Reflection	8	S	50
Module 8 subtotal			***280***
TOTAL			**731**
HubSpot Social Media Certification (optional)	n/a	Bonus	+10

Grading Scale

The table below lists the letter grade for each point range and its corresponding percentage range.

Grade	Points	Percentage
A	658 to 731	90 to 100%
B	585 to 657	80 to 89%
C	512 to 584	70 to 79%
D	439 to 511	60 to 69%
F	below 439	below 60%

Grading Rubrics

Every rubric row is scored at fixed fractions of its points, with nothing in between. A row worth 10 points or more scores full, three-quarter, half, quarter, or no credit; on a four-band rubric those are Exemplary, Proficient, Developing, Beginning, and missing. A row worth less than 10 points scores full, half, or no credit; on a four-band rubric, Exemplary and Proficient earn full credit, Developing earns half, and Beginning or missing earns none. On a Full / Partial / No Credit rubric, Partial earns half. On a checklist item, half credit means the item is there but misses one stated requirement, and no credit means it is missing or misses more than one. You are welcome to contact me with point disputes during office hours. In special cases, opportunities to address mistakes for partial credit are provided.

The Syllabus Quiz and any Blackboard quizzes in this course are untimed, and you may take multiple attempts. If any timed element is ever added in the future, it will be announced in advance with ACCESS-coordinated lead time so that accommodations can be arranged.

Feedback and Grading Timeline

Grades with feedback will be posted by the Friday following the due date for formative assignments and within 7 days for summative assignments. Feedback on the Module 7 SWOT Draft and Timeline Draft is returned by Monday, December 14, when Module 8 opens. Final Pitch Deck feedback will arrive within 48 hours of the due date since final grades are due shortly after. You can find your grade by clicking My Grades on the left menu of the Blackboard course.

Due Days

Most work is due Sunday at 11:59 p.m. Central time. These items are due on another day, and each one says so on its own page and in its module overview:

- the first post in the Introduction Discussion, Wednesday, October 21, in the Platform Reflection Discussion, Wednesday, October 28, and in the Disagreement Discussion, Wednesday, November 11 (replies are due that Sunday);
- the Module 6 Peer Review, Tuesday, December 8;
- the Module 7 SWOT Draft and Timeline Draft, Thursday, December 10;
- everything in Module 8 (Final Pitch Deck, AI Workflow Appendix, Elevator Pitch, Final Reflection, and the optional HubSpot certification), Friday, December 18, the last day of the term.

Late or Missed Assignments

Assignments are due before or on the date specified. Late assignments lose 10% per business day for up to one week. After one week, the assignment receives a zero unless an accommodation has been arranged in writing before the original due date.

An 8-week course does not have the schedule flexibility of a 16-week course. If you are experiencing an emergency, contact me as early as possible. I will work with you on a case-by-case basis when contacted proactively. I cannot extend deadlines retroactively.

Rewrites

Formative assignments (type F) may be revised and resubmitted within one week of grade posting for full credit. Summative assignments (type S) worth 30 points or more may be resubmitted once. The resubmission is averaged with the original, and if it scores lower, the original grade stands. Six assignments qualify, each with a fixed resubmission date: the AI-Assisted Research Plan, Sunday, November 22; the Comparison Memo and the Statistical Analysis Memo, Sunday, December 6; the AI Creative Brief Exercise, Friday, December 18; and the SWOT Draft and Timeline Draft, Friday, December 18, where the resubmission is the revised SWOT and timeline you build for your deck, attached as one extra PDF. These dates are fixed: a grade posted early does not move them, and a late resubmission is not accepted. The Module 8 assignments and summative work under 30 points cannot be resubmitted.

Participation and Regular and Substantive Interaction (RSI)

RSI is required for distance education under U.S. Department of Education regulations. In this course, RSI takes the form of:

- A weekly announcement video from the instructor at the start of each module.
- Weekly office hours as a live, confidential support channel: remote on Tuesday, Wednesday and Thursday afternoons over Teams, scheduled through Microsoft Bookings or by email.
- Substantive instructor responses on each discussion forum (on a weekly cadence rather than continuous).

- Personalized written feedback on graded submissions, on the timeline above.
- Optional 1:1 remote check-ins by appointment, particularly for Module 5 (Statistical Analysis) and the Final Pitch Deck.

Why a weekly cadence fits this course. SIUE recommends opportunities for regular and substantive interaction at least once per week in standard 16-week courses and at least twice per week in accelerated courses. MC 427 is accelerated, and it meets that recommendation through opportunity rather than through a second scheduled broadcast: office hours are open three afternoons every week (Tuesday, Wednesday and Thursday), and email is answered within 24 hours on weekdays. The instructor-initiated interaction (the announcement video, forum responses, and written feedback) runs weekly because each module is one week long, so every module receives its own direct instruction, discussion response, and feedback rather than sharing them with another module. Federal rules ask that interaction be predictable and commensurate with the length of the course and the amount of content; one full cycle in every one-week module is how this course answers it.

Your part in RSI is to engage with the course on a weekly cadence: read the assigned materials, watch the lecture videos, post to discussions, attend the office hour when you have questions, and submit work on time. Self-study is rarely sufficient for material this new; consistent engagement is the strongest predictor of a strong final pitch.

This course includes an anonymous mid-course pulse survey and an anonymous end-of-course design-feedback survey. Your responses are read carefully and shape how this course runs, both during the term and in future offerings, so please take a few minutes to complete them.

Course Recordings

All lecture content is pre-recorded and posted to the module before the module opens. Office hours are not recorded: under FERPA, recording a support session where students raise grades, accommodations, or personal circumstances would defeat its purpose, so those conversations stay live and private. Asynchronous Elevator Pitch videos in Module 8 are recorded by students and posted to the Module 8 discussion.

Course Policies and University Policies

Academic Integrity

Students are reminded that the expectations and academic standards outlined in the *Student Academic Code (3C2)* apply to all courses at the University, regardless of modality.

Plagiarism (use of another person's words or ideas without credit) and cheating will not be tolerated and may lead to failure on an assignment, in the class, or dismissal from the University, per the *SIUE academic dishonesty policy*.

This course operates under a **course-specific AI Use Policy** that authorizes and requires AI use as part of the certificate program design. See the AI Use Policy section above for documentation and evaluation expectations. **The default SIUE prohibition on AI use does not apply in this course.** AI use without disclosure or AI use that fabricates citations, data, or analytical results remains academic dishonesty.

Diversity and Inclusion

SIUE is committed to respecting everyone's dignity at all times. Our virtual classroom must be a place where students and instructors feel safe and supported. Systems of oppression permeate our institutions and our classrooms; all students and instructors share responsibility for affirming inclusion, equity, and social justice. Racism, sexism, classism, ableism, heterosexism, xenophobia, and other social pathologies will not be tolerated. Violations will be enforced in line with the SIUE Student Conduct Code.

The Inclusive Excellence, Education, and Development Hub is a resource for students. Concerns can be directed to Lindy Wagner, Assistant Vice Chancellor for Inclusive Excellence, Education and Development, at (618) 650-3179 or linwagn@siue.edu.

Pregnancy and Newly Parenting Policy

This course follows *SIUE's Newly Parenting Policy (3C15)*. Students may request accommodations through the Office of Equal Opportunity, Access, and Title IX Coordination (EOA).

Technology Privacy

This course uses Blackboard. Review the *Anthology Blackboard Privacy Statement* for data handling. The course also uses third-party AI tools (ChatGPT or Claude, and GitHub Copilot); their privacy policies are linked in Start Here, under Tool Policies and Accessibility.

Subject to Change Notice

All material, assignments, and deadlines are subject to change with prior notice. Watch the course announcements and Blackboard regularly.

Additional Support

Services for Students Needing Accommodations

It is the policy and practice of SIUE to create inclusive learning environments. If aspects of the instruction or design of this course create barriers to your inclusion or to accurate assessment of achievement (time-limited assessments, inaccessible content, non-captioned videos), please contact *Accessible Campus Community and Equitable Student Support (ACCESS)* as soon as possible. Students must register with ACCESS online at siue.edu/access or in person in the Student Success Center, Room 1203. Email myaccess@siue.edu or call 618-650-3726.

Academic and Other Student Services

- *Lovejoy Library Resources*
- *Academic Success Sessions*
- *Tutoring Resource Center*
- *The Writing Center*
- *Academic Advising*
- *Financial Aid*
- *Counseling Services*

Cougar Care

College life can be challenging, and I support students prioritizing mental health. Counseling is available at the Student Success Center, 0222. Make an appointment at *cougarcare.siue.edu* or call 618-650-2842.

Technical Support

This is a fully online course. Reliable computer and internet access is required. Technical problems are not an excuse for missed deadlines, but they can often be resolved quickly. Contact ITS at 618-650-5500 or help@siue.edu, check *ITS System Status*, or search the *ITS KnowledgeBase*.

Course Schedule

The schedule is subject to change. See Blackboard for the current version.

Module	Dates	Topic	Major Submission Due
1	Oct 19 to 25	Foundations and AI Governance for the Working Strategist	Syllabus Quiz · Introduction Discussion (first post Wed Oct 21) · AI Tool Inventory · Tools Stack Setup · AI Use Log Wk 1

Module	Dates	Topic	Major Submission Due
2	Oct 26 to Nov 1	Platforms and Metrics: KPIs in the Age of AI	AI-Assisted KPI Mapping Exercise · Platform Reflection Discussion (first post Wed Oct 28) · AI Use Log Wk 2
3	Nov 2 to 8	Data Collection and AI-Assisted Research Design	AI-Assisted Research Plan · AI Use Log Wk 3
4	Nov 9 to 15	Content and Sentiment Analysis with AI	Coding Exercise · Comparison Memo · Disagreement Discussion (first post Wed Nov 11) · AI Use Log Wk 4
5	Nov 16 to 22	Statistical Analysis with R, VS Code, and GitHub Copilot	Mini-Analysis Exercise · Statistical Analysis Memo · AI Use Log Wk 5
Break	Nov 23 to 29	Thanksgiving Break (no module, no assignments)	None
6	Nov 30 to Dec 6	SMART Goals and Strategic Application of AI Creative	AI Creative Brief Exercise · AI Use Log Wk 6 · Peer Review (due Tue Dec 8)
7	Dec 7 to 13	Strategy Synthesis: SWOT, Timelines, Stakeholder Communication	SWOT Draft and Timeline Draft (due Thu Dec 10) · Peer Review of Draft Strategy Work · AI Use Log Wk 7
8	Dec 14 to 18	Final Pitch: AI-Augmented Strategy Presentation	**Final Pitch Deck + AI Workflow Appendix** · Elevator Pitch · Final Reflection (all due Fri Dec 18)

Note on the final weeks: Thanksgiving week (Nov 23 to 29) has no module and no assignments. Modules 6, 7, and 8 each run for one week after the break, and the term ends Friday, December 18. Module 8 is a single focused week centered on the Final Pitch Deck; the AI Workflow Appendix opens in Module 7, and the draft peer review sits in Module 7, so neither compresses into the final week. Office hours continue throughout; attendance is strongly encouraged for students with questions about the pitch deck or presentation.